

PHOTO BY **BANDEEP SINGH**

AT HOME WITH HERITAGE

Radhikaraje Gaekwad, of the Baroda royal family, heads the family museum that has 45 Raja Ravi Varma paintings

in the world. The Royal Family of Baroda lives at the confluence of a world where old meets new, where architectural heritage and tradition are interwoven with traces of modernity.

“When I buy something, I think about the story and journey behind it, about how it’s a dying craft and it may not survive another 20 years if we don’t support it and the community that creates them today. So, I invest in it, and talk about it and encourage others to purchase it too. I have never regretted buying a craft item,” says Gaekwad. She says Indian luxury ruled the world, and it’s having a moment globally again because the crafts are being recognised. “We still have them, while countries like China have lost them completely as the next generation is desensitised and detached from them,” she says.

Reddy believes that India has a lot of talent, whether it is jewellery or textiles, but we are unable to sell the story. “Look at how they do it abroad. Even for a small piece of textile they will create such a

big story. India is lacking in that,” says the fashionista, who is equally comfortable wearing Indian designers such as Falguni Shane Peacock or Tarun Tahiliani and global brands like Schiaparelli, as long as the outfits are customised for her. “A designer can create something for you, but you have your own image in mind, so the two should match. An experienced designer will always take your inputs and your feedback and modify designs accordingly.”

At the end of the day, as Reddy says, luxury is about being yourself. **BT**

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